

NEGOTIATION WITH A THIEF

Our heroes need more information on the Q'irin dwarves, a criminal organization at odds with the heroes. Their operations remain close to the chest, and few people know the first thing about them.

One such person is a local pickpocket, a young human girl named Volkir the Swipe.

You can use one of the following hooks for this encounter, replacing any of the named concepts with elements from your own campaign:

Psst. Hey You! A small, cloaked figure beckons the heroes from a dark alley. She noticed they were having trouble with her boss and wanted to talk about helping each other out.

Swiper No Swiping. The pickpocket brushes past one of the heroes, swipes an item, and makes a break for it, only to trip a few feet away. On closer examination the heroes notice her cloak bears the same emblem of the crime family they've been dealing with! She's willing to talk if the heroes forget that she made a rookie mistake.

No Honor Among Thieves. The heroes catch a glimpse of three dwarves leaving behind a sad, young human. If they approach her, she mentions that she couldn't make her quota, and the boss threatened to kill her if she failed him again. She'd rather get revenge.

Volkir the Swipe

Stubborn Young Thief

The Q'irin family adopted Volkir at an early age and immediately put her to work picking pockets. She's one of the best at what she does, but she doesn't feel appreciated by her family. Volkir either wants someone to teach her family a lesson, or find a way to get out of this line of work completely and enjoy her youth. However, she knows this could put her life on the line and won't spill any details unless the heroes prove up to the task.

Playing Volkir

Volkir can be crass. Whenever she can't think of a response quick enough, she quietly curses in Zaliac under her breath.

The longer negotiations go on for, she starts to get cold feet and second guess her choices. The pickpocket owes a lot to the Q'irin family. However, if the heroes take the time to learn about Volkir and convince her she's being used by criminals, her revelry pitfall turns into a motivation.

Encounter Credits

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Volkir the Swipe

Species: Human

Combat Stat Block: Goblin Guide (*Draw Steel: Monsters*)

Skills: Hide, Pick Lock, Pick Pocket

Languages: Zaliac (Native), Caelian, Szech

Interest: 2

Patience: 2

Impression: 1

Motivations

Protection: The pickpocket needs assurance that she'll be safe before agreeing to any deals. She knows how dangerous her family can be. As negotiations go on, she also wants guarantees for certain family members after all the good they did for her.

Vengeance: The pickpocket has beef with the dwarves after they hurt her pride. Any deal can't end with the family being chased off; they need to be *humiliated*. Although, she'll settle for seeing the boss' face one more time before he's defeated.

Pitfall

Revelry: Volkir acts tough because the family taught her that she needs to be strong. She has no time for games. Deep down, however, she wants to have fun and learn about the world. If the heroes make her realize she was being used, this pitfall becomes a motivation.

Greed: Volkir gets insulted by fortune or wealth being handed to her after years of being valued by the Q'irin family for her thieving abilities. Any offer of coin is met with "You think I couldn't swipe that bag myself?"

Negotiation with Volkir the Swipe can have the following outcomes:

- **Interest 5:** Not only does Volkir reveal everything the heroes want to know about the crime family, she feels comfortable enough to work with the heroes directly as a retainer and lead them into the family hideout.
- **Interest 4:** The pickpocket nervously reveals everything she knows about the Q'irin family and leaves the rest in the heroes' hands.
- **Interest 3:** Volkir will tell the heroes everything she knows, but only after they help her to trick the Q'irin family into believing she's already dead.
- **Interest 2:** The pickpocket doesn't feel safe enough to snatch on her family. However, the heroes get a tip from "someone who is not named Volkir" about the typical haunt of one of the boss' lieutenants.
- **Interest 1:** Volkir thinks better of revealing any critical information.
- **Interest 0:** Volkir changes her mind and decides to call off any deals. She runs off. For the next week, the heroes are assaulted by Q'irin agents whenever they start a respite.

If the heroes get useful information on the Q'irin, they earn 1 Victory.

Rewards

A hero can earn the following reward:

Retainer: Volkir the Swipe

Prerequisites: End a negotiation with Volkir at Interest 5.

The pickpocket is willing to join the heroes to get back at the Q'irin family and their boss. After all, "you'd be lost without help from The Swipe."